

**UNIVERSITY OF NOTRE DAME**  
**Department of Economics**  
**Summer 2024**

**ECON 10010/20010: Principles of Microeconomics**

**Instructor:** Pietro Pellerito (ppelleri@nd.edu)

**Class Time:** Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday 10:30 am – 12:45 pm

**Class Location:** 216 DeBartolo Hall

**Office Hour Times and Locations:** Mondays/Wednesdays 1:00-2:30 pm in 3005 Jenkins Nanovic Hall

Tuesdays/Thursdays 9:00 - 10:00 am in 3031 Jenkins Nanovic Hall

By Appointment in 3031 Jenkins Nanovic Hall

**Course Description**

This course will introduce you to the study of microeconomics. Economics is the study of how individuals and groups make decisions given that resources (e.g. raw materials, time, energy) are scarce. Over the following five weeks, we will use microeconomic theory to study topics such as advantages to trade, market forces, consumer and firm decision-making, and more. We will also connect the principles and theories learned in class to both historical and contemporaneous real-world examples. At the end of the course, you will have developed skills required to “think like an economist” and apply these tools to further understand economic research in subjects such as labor markets, education, crime, and family structures, among others.

**Required Course Materials**

1. A phone/tablet with access to Poll Everywhere software
2. *Microeconomics* by Hubbard and O’Brien, Eighth Edition<sup>+</sup>

*+Note:* This textbook is an additional resource for reviewing concepts covered in class. You will NOT be responsible for the material in the textbook not covered in class.

**Requirements and Grade Weighting**

- A. **Participation (15%)** Everyone is expected to participate in class. Your participation grade will be determined using the Poll Everywhere (henceforth PE) software. During class, I will pause on certain slides to present multiple-choice questions, which you will be responsible for answering using the PE app. The anonymized distribution of responses will be displayed in the slides in real-time. The PE app is free, and we will take time during our first class to ensure everyone downloads it properly. No devices other than a smartphone or tablet may be used to interact with PE questions. PE questions are graded based on participation, NOT accuracy. To account for illnesses, technical problems, and other unforeseen circumstances, there will be a 10-percentage-point curve applied to your participation grade (not to exceed a total score of 100%). This equates to a day of participation.
- B. **Reaction Statements (5%)** Each week I will provide a newspaper article, podcast, or other media commentary on a previously covered material. You are expected to respond to the post by summarizing the content and how it relates to a given economic topic. In class, I will call on several students to present what they have prepared. All students will present their reaction statement at least once during the course. I will collect all reaction statements in class, which are graded on completion.

- C. **Problem Sets (25%)** There will be 5 problem sets assigned throughout the course. You are allowed (and encouraged) to work on these problem sets in groups. However, you must turn in your OWN solutions. I encourage you to put forth a considerable amount of effort on problem sets since they are designed to help you grasp the concepts discussed in class. Problem sets are graded based on accuracy. Late problem sets without a valid excuse from the Dean will receive at most half credit. Problem-set due dates are set by the schedule provided later in this syllabus, and all problem sets will be collected in class. I will return graded problem sets to you the next class, unless otherwise notified.
- D. **Quizzes (25%)** There will be four quizzes throughout the class, which will test your mastery of the recently reviewed topics. All quizzes will take place in the last 40 minutes of class. A calculator and a single pre-prepared 3x5-inch notecard are allowed during the quiz. There are no makeup quizzes for unexcused absences, and missed quizzes via an unexcused absence will receive a zero score. I will return graded quizzes to you in the next class unless otherwise notified.
- E. **Final Exam (30%)** The final exam will take place in class (July 18<sup>th</sup>) in our classroom (216 DeBartolo Hall). Per ND rules, you must have a valid excuse from the Dean to take the final exam at a time other than the scheduled time. Other university exam policies can be found online (<https://registrar.nd.edu/exams-grading/exam-information/>). Missed final exams without a valid excuse from the Dean will receive a final score of zero. For the final, you are allowed to bring in a calculator and an 8.5 x 11-inch sheet of paper of pre-prepared notes.

In summary, final grades for the course will be based on the following:

|                     |     |
|---------------------|-----|
| Participation       | 15% |
| Reaction Statements | 5%  |
| Problem Sets        | 25% |
| Quizzes             | 25% |
| Final               | 30% |

Letter grades will be assigned as follows:

|    |          |
|----|----------|
| A  | 93-100   |
| A- | 90-92.99 |
| B+ | 87-89.99 |
| B  | 83-86.99 |
| B- | 80-82.99 |
| C+ | 77-79.99 |
| C  | 73-76.99 |
| C- | 70-72.99 |
| D  | 60-69.99 |
| F  | 0-59.99  |

### Canvas

The course website within Canvas (<https://canvas.nd.edu/>) will have the class slides, assignment information, and more. Please check the website regularly for class updates.

### Grade Updates

You are encouraged to contact me (either over email or during office hours) if you would like to know where your overall grade stands. Furthermore, I will provide overall grade updates to all students both halfway through the course, as well as before the final exam. Final grades will be available to students shortly after the course ends and can be accessed at <https://inside.nd.edu/> once ready.

## **Supplementary Material**

Practice is vital for success, which is why I provide practice problems and material (both from the textbook and elsewhere) for each topic covered in class on our Canvas website. I will not grade these supplementary assignments, but encourage you to utilize them and contact me if there are any questions.

## **Attendance and Participation**

Attendance is required and factors into the course grade through PE participation. A large portion of lecture time will be devoted to discussion and group collaboration, so it's important that everyone participates for the class to benefit as a whole. Other than phones/tablets as means to access PE, no electronic devices (i.e., laptops) are permitted during class. However, if you believe it would be useful to take notes with a tablet please let me know during the first week of class so we can discuss an exception. If you are observed to be using an unapproved electronic device I will take points off your participation grade.

## **Email Communications**

I will communicate class announcements by emailing your @nd.edu address. Please check your email regularly for updates. I will do my best to respond to your emails within 24 hours.

## **Academic Honesty**

This course is designed to prepare you for success as you advance in your academic careers. Apart from class attendance and participation, study skills, and exam performance, it is crucial for you to practice academic honesty to be successful here at Notre Dame. Thus all students are required to abide by the University's Honor Code (<https://honorcode.nd.edu/>). This code is taken extremely seriously, and every semester a handful of students receive ramifications for breaking it – do not be that individual! Success in this class that comes from sacrificing your integrity is not worth it in the long run.

This course also serves as the basis for more advanced economics and business courses. Your future self will thank you for developing a solid understanding of the material now. For this reason, while collaboration on problem sets is encouraged, copying is prohibited. Furthermore, the use of AI technology to solve problem sets or write response statements is strictly prohibited. However, you are allowed to use AI technology to help you understand concepts covered in class. If you are concerned if use of AI technology will violate the honor code, please ask me about it first.

## **Class Recordings**

I plan to record our lectures as a resource for students with excused absences. Students will not be visible in the recordings – the video will only show me and the chalkboard/slides. If you believe a class recording will inhibit your ability to participate in class, please let me know during the first few weeks of class.

## **Disability-Related Accommodations**

Any student who has a documented disability and is registered with Sara Bea Accessibility Services should speak with me as soon as possible regarding accommodations. Students who are not registered but require accommodations should contact [Sara Bea Accessibility Services](#) as soon as possible.

## **Excused Absences**

Excused absences will only be granted due to an officially-sanctioned University events/activities, illness, or unforeseen emergency. Please communicate with me prior to any excused absence, and I will follow up by providing documentation to verify the absence. I will also be sure to work with you by providing a recording of the lecture or with a personal appointment so that you do not fall behind on any of the material.

## **Inclusiveness**

The University of Notre Dame is committed to social justice. I share that commitment and strive to maintain a positive learning environment based on open communication, mutual respect, and non-discrimination. Any

suggestions as to how to further such an open and positive environment will be appreciated and given serious consideration.

### Lauren's Promise

I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening or harassing you.

Lauren McCluskey, a 21-year-old student at the University of Utah and the daughter of economist Jill McCluskey, was murdered on October 22nd, 2018, by a man she briefly dated. I am committed to doing what I can to make sure this does not happen again.

If you are in immediate danger, call 911. If you are experiencing sexual assault, domestic violence, stalking, or harassment you can report it to me. You should be aware that I am a mandatory reporter, which means that I am required to report these instances to the university's Title IX Coordinator or Deputy Title IX Coordinator to investigate. You can also learn about your options (both on and off-campus as well as confidential or not) at <http://titleix.nd.edu>.

### Mental Health

Diminished mental health can interfere with optimal academic performance. The source of symptoms might be related to your coursework; if so, please speak with me. However, problems with other parts of your life can also contribute to decreased academic performance. The University Counseling Center (UCC) provides cost-free and confidential mental health services to help you manage personal challenges that threaten your emotional or academic well-being. Remember, getting help is a smart and courageous thing to do – for yourself and for those who care about you. For more resources, please see [ucc.nd.edu](http://ucc.nd.edu) or [supportandcare.nd.edu](http://supportandcare.nd.edu).

### Tentative Schedule (Subject to Change)

| Date           | #   | Topic(s)                               | Announcements and Assignments            |
|----------------|-----|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Wednesday 6/19 | 1   | Intro, Opportunity Cost, Trade         | PS #1 Available, Reaction #1 Available   |
| Thursday 6/20  | 2   | Demand                                 | Reaction #1 Due                          |
| Monday 6/24    | 3   | Supply, Equilibrium Analysis           | PS #1 Due, PS #2 Available               |
| Tuesday 6/25   | 4   | Equilibrium Analysis                   | Quiz #1 Date, Reaction #2 Available      |
| Wednesday 6/26 | 5   | Equilibrium Analysis, Elasticity       | Reaction #2 Due                          |
| Thursday 6/27  | 6   | Elasticity, Regulation (Price Control) | PS #2 Due (Friday 6/28), PS #3 Available |
| Monday 7/1     | 7   | Gov. Regulation (Taxes)                | Quiz #2 Date, Reaction #3 Available      |
| Tuesday 7/2    | 8   | Gov. Regulation (Subsidies)            | Reaction #3 Due                          |
| Wednesday 7/3  | 9   | Externalities, Public Goods            | PS #3 Due (Friday 7/5)                   |
| Thursday 7/4   | --- | <b>No Class -- July 4th</b>            |                                          |
| Monday 7/8     | 10  | Coase Theorem, Producer Theory         | PS #4 Available                          |
| Tuesday 7/9    | 11  | Producer Theory                        | Quiz #3 Date, Reaction #4 Available      |
| Wednesday 7/10 | 12  | Perfect Competition                    | Reaction #4 Due                          |
| Thursday 7/11  | 13  | Monopolies                             | PS #4 Due, PS #5 Available               |
| Monday 7/15    | 14  | Oligopoly, Game Theory                 | Quiz #4 Date, Reaction #5 Available      |
| Tuesday 7/16   | 15  | Game Theory, Special Topic(s)          | Reaction #5 Due                          |
| Wednesday 7/17 | 16  | Review                                 | PS#5 Due                                 |
| Thursday 7/18  | 17  | <b>Final Exam</b>                      |                                          |